Design System

An original visual language for three very different contexts: a guest's phone at a table, a kitchen screen read from two metres, and a dense desktop dashboard. Nothing here is extracted from the source product, whose visuals were not captured; the palette, type and components are proposals you should adjust to your brand.

1. Principles

1. **Food first.** On the guest app, photography and price carry the page; chrome stays quiet.
2. **One thumb.** Every guest action is reachable in the lower two-thirds of a phone screen; the primary action is a sticky bottom bar.
3. **Glanceable under pressure.** Kitchen and live-board screens are read in under a second: big type, status by colour and by label, never colour alone.
4. **State is always visible.** Order status, connection status and payment status are shown, not implied.
5. **Same tokens, three densities.** Guest (comfortable), Dashboard (compact), KDS (large).

2. Colour tokens

Define as CSS variables and map into Tailwind. Check every text/background pair for 4.5:1 contrast before shipping; the values below are starting points.

Brand and neutrals

Token	Light	Dark (KDS default)	Use
`--color-primary`	#E4572E	#FF7A52	Primary buttons, active states
`--color-primary-fg`	#FFFFFF	#1A1A1A	Text on primary
`--color-bg`	#FAFAF7	#111315	Page background
`--color-surface`	#FFFFFF	#1B1E21	Cards, sheets
`--color-surface-2`	#F2F1EC	#25292D	Subtle fills, table headers
`--color-border`	#E3E1DA	#343A40	Dividers, inputs
`--color-text`	#1C1B19	#F3F2EE	Body text
`--color-text-muted`	#6B6860	#A7A39A	Secondary text

Semantic

Token	Value	Use
`--color-success`	#1E8E5A	Paid, ready, available
`--color-warning`	#C98A04	Waiting too long, low stock
`--color-danger`	#C93A3A	Overdue, rejected, failed payment
`--color-info`	#2B6CB0	Informational
`--color-veg`	#1E8E5A	Veg mark (green square with dot, Indian convention)
`--color-nonveg`	#B23A2E	Non-veg mark

Order status (always paired with a text label and icon)

Status	Token	Value	Label
placed	`--status-placed`	#2B6CB0	New
accepted	`--status-accepted`	#6B46C1	Accepted
preparing	`--status-preparing`	#C98A04	Preparing
ready	`--status-ready`	#1E8E5A	Ready
served	`--status-served`	#6B6860	Served
cancelled / rejected	`--status-cancelled`	#C93A3A	Cancelled

3. Typography

Token	Family	Use
`--font-sans`	Inter (variable), system fallback	All UI
`--font-display`	Plus Jakarta Sans or your brand face	Outlet name, big numbers
`--font-mono`	JetBrains Mono, tabular numerals	Order numbers, tokens, timers

Style	Size / line height	Weight	Guest	Dashboard	KDS
display	32 / 40	700	Order number, token	KPI numbers	Table/token on ticket (use 40 / 44)
h1	24 / 32	700	Outlet name	Page title	Column title
h2	20 / 28	600	Category title	Section title	Item name (use 22 / 28)
body	16 / 24	400	Default	14 / 20	18 / 26
small	14 / 20	400	Descriptions	13 / 18	16 / 22
caption	12 / 16	500	Tags	Table meta	Avoid on KDS

Use tabular numerals for all prices, quantities and timers. Format currency as `₹1,250` with Indian grouping; show paise only when non-zero.

4. Spacing, radius, elevation, motion

Token group	Values
Spacing (4 px base)	0, 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64
Radius	sm 6, md 10, lg 16, pill 999
Shadow	sm `0 1px 2px rgb(0 0 0 / .06)`; md `0 4px 12px rgb(0 0 0 / .08)`; sheet `0 -8px 24px rgb(0 0 0 / .12)`
Motion	fast 120 ms, base 200 ms, slow 320 ms; ease `cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1)`; respect `prefers-reduced-motion`
Breakpoints	sm 640, md 768, lg 1024, xl 1280
Touch targets	Minimum 44 x 44 px guest and dashboard; 56 px on KDS
Z-index	base 0, sticky 10, drawer 20, sheet 30, modal 40, toast 50

5. Layout by surface

Surface	Layout
Guest	Single column, max width 480 px centred on larger screens. Sticky header (outlet, table), sticky horizontal category tabs, sticky bottom cart bar. Bottom sheets instead of modals.
KDS	Full-screen, dark theme, landscape. Columns by status (New, Preparing, Ready) or a ticket grid of 3 to 5 columns. No scrolling within a ticket where avoidable.
Dashboard	Left sidebar 240 px (collapsible to 64 px), top bar with outlet switcher, content max width 1440 px, 12-column grid, 24 px gutters.
Canteen panel	Dashboard shell with a two-pane live view: queue left, selected order right.

Surface	Layout
Pickup display	Full-screen, two lists: Preparing and Ready, token numbers in display type.

6. Components

Build on shadcn/ui primitives; each component below is a wrapper with fixed variants. Every interactive component needs default, hover, focus-visible, active, disabled and loading states.

Primitives

Component	Variants / notes
Button	primary, secondary, ghost, danger; sizes sm, md, lg, xl (KDS); loading spinner replaces label, width stays fixed
IconButton	Requires `aria-label`
Input, Textarea, Select, Switch, Checkbox, Radio	Label above, helper and error text below
QuantityStepper	Minus, count, plus; minus becomes remove at 1
Badge	neutral, status (uses status tokens), veg / non-veg mark
Chip	Filter chips, selectable, horizontally scrollable
Card	surface, border, radius md
Sheet	Bottom sheet on mobile, side drawer on desktop
Dialog	Confirmations only (reject, cancel, refund)
Toast	Success, error, info; 4 s; one at a time on guest
Tabs, Table, Pagination, DropdownMenu, Tooltip	Dashboard
Skeleton	For menu list, order board, KPI cards
EmptyState	Icon, one line, one action

Component	Variants / notes
ConnectionBanner	"Reconnecting..." strip on KDS and guest tracking

Guest components

Component	Anatomy and behaviour
OutletHeader	Logo, outlet name, table label or "Pickup", open/closed
CategoryTabs	Sticky; scroll-spy highlights the category in view; tap scrolls to it
SearchBar + DietaryFilters	Search by name; chips for Veg, Vegan, Jain, Gluten-free, Spicy
MenuItemCard	Image 96 x 96 right, veg mark, name, 2-line description, price, Add button; sold-out state greyed with label
ItemSheet	Large image, description, variant radio group, add-on groups with min/max hints, note field, stepper, "Add ₹X" button
CartBar	Sticky bottom: item count, total, "View cart"; hidden when empty
CartSheet	Lines with stepper, order note, bill summary, "Place order"
BillSummary	Subtotal, taxes (CGST/SGST), service charge, total
OrderStatusTracker	Vertical stepper: Placed, Accepted, Preparing, Ready, Served; current step animated; timestamps
TokenCard	Canteen: token number in display type, status, "Show at counter"
PaymentSheet	Amount due, UPI and card options, pay-at-counter option if enabled
ServiceActions	Call waiter, request bill

Kitchen components

Component	Anatomy and behaviour
KdsTicket	Header: table or token, order number, elapsed timer. Body: qty x item, variant and add-ons indented, notes highlighted. Footer: one full-width action (Start, Mark ready). Border colour by age: normal, warning, overdue
KdsColumn	Title with count; newest at bottom
NewOrderAlert	Sound plus a brief flash on the new ticket; mute toggle
StationFilter	Segmented control (Phase 2)

Dashboard components

Component	Anatomy and behaviour
KpiCard	Label, value, delta vs previous period
OrdersBoard	Group by table; each group shows orders, statuses, running total, actions
TableTile	Label, seats, state (free, occupied, bill requested), elapsed time, amount
OrderDrawer	Full order detail, timeline from `order_events`, actions
MenuEditor	Category list (drag to reorder) and item table with inline availability switch
ItemForm	Image upload with crop, price, tags, variants, add-on groups
QrCard	QR preview, table label, download and regenerate
SettleBillDialog	Amount due, payment method split, close table
Charts	Line (sales over time), bar (top items), heat grid (orders by hour and weekday)

7. Content and microcopy

- Plain, short, friendly. Buttons are verbs: "Add", "Place order", "Pay ₹450", "Mark ready".

- Errors say what happened and what to do: "Paneer Tikka just sold out. Remove it to continue."
- Empty states: "No orders yet. New orders will appear here."
- Never blame the guest for network failures; offer retry.

8. Iconography and imagery

- Icons: Lucide, 1.5 px stroke, 20 px default, 24 px on KDS.
- Item images: square, minimum 600 x 600 upload, served at 96, 192 and 600 px; neutral placeholder when missing.
- QR print template: A6 table tent with your logo, table label, the QR at 35 mm minimum, and one line of instruction.

9. Accessibility

- WCAG 2.1 AA: contrast, focus-visible rings (2 px, `--color-primary`), logical tab order.
- Status never conveyed by colour alone.
- Bottom sheets trap focus and close on Escape; live status changes announced through an `aria-live="polite"` region.
- Supports 200% text zoom without loss of function on the guest app.

10. Token file for the agent

Put this in `apps/web/app/tokens.css` and reference the variables from `tailwind.config.ts`; components must use tokens, never raw hex values.

```
:root {
  --color-primary: #E4572E;  --color-primary-fg: #FFFFFF;
  --color-bg: #FAFAF7;       --color-surface: #FFFFFF;
  --color-surface-2: #F2F1EC; --color-border: #E3E1DA;
  --color-text: #1C1B19;     --color-text-muted: #6B6860;
  --color-success: #1E8E5A;  --color-warning: #C98A04;
  --color-danger: #C93A3A;   --color-info: #2B6CB0;
  --status-placed: #2B6CB0;  --status-accepted: #6B46C1;
  --status-preparing: #C98A04; --status-ready: #1E8E5A;
  --status-served: #6B6860;  --status-cancelled: #C93A3A;
  --radius-sm: 6px; --radius-md: 10px; --radius-lg: 16px;
  --motion-fast: 120ms; --motion-base: 200ms; --motion-slow: 320ms;
}
[data-theme="dark"] {
  --color-primary: #FF7A52;  --color-primary-fg: #1A1A1A;
  --color-bg: #111315;       --color-surface: #1B1E21;
  --color-surface-2: #25292D; --color-border: #343A40;
  --color-text: #F3F2EE;     --color-text-muted: #A7A39A;
}
```